



Hendo Hoverboard

As a result of a successful Kickstarter campaign, Hendo has made an actual, real working hoverboard. <https://digit.in/Aug18-45-1>



The Amazing Star Cube

This desk toy from California Creations is a shapeshifting cube that can be configured into various forms. <https://digit.in/Aug18-45-2>

buttons. MOBA gamers will definitely love this gamepad. On the iOS side of things, a similar process has to be followed where you need to install an app and the games need to be launched through it. Only then would the gamepad connect to the device. All of these extra features are great; however, it could be overwhelming for some who aren't really interested in changing up things. In conclusion, if you're an advanced user, only then should you consider going for this gamepad.

STEELSERIES STRATUS

It's difficult to come across portable and reliable gamepads officially selling in the country. We could only find the Stratus from SteelSeries, and it's only compatible with iOS. It would have been a bonus if the company had an equivalent model which supported Android as well. The Stratus is a full-fledged gamepad, complete with all the buttons and analog sticks you'd need for mobile gaming. It fits in your pocket easily, automatically becoming the most portable gamepad in this comparison. There are four LEDs to display the battery level which can be charged through the micro-USB port. There are two analog sticks at the middle but there aren't any buttons beneath them. This means the gamepad doesn't have L3 and R3 buttons. Both the analog sticks have the same resistance to movement. It would have been great if the right joystick was smoother so that it worked better in shooting games. There's an on/off switch on the right side and the Bluetooth broadcast can be started with the button on the back of the device. A cover for the back is packed in the box that gives you a more ergonomic grip while holding the gamepad. Because of the small size, there isn't a smartphone holder on the gamepad. However, if you remove the back cover, it can be placed on a surface to be used like the controls on arcade machines, albeit, much smaller ones.

Pairing the Stratus was simple and didn't require any additional steps. If the game supports the gamepad, you'll be able to dive straight into the game.

All the games listed down on their website allows you to control the game right from the menu with the gamepad. We found it worked really well with racing and platformer games. The right joystick doesn't allow the appropriate smoothness required to move the crosshair accurately. All the buttons on the Stratus are membrane ones so they don't really make too



SteelSeries Stratus

much noise. The action buttons don't wobble much and they don't give off a rattling noise while smashing them. When it comes to portability, comfort and features, the Stratus gives you all of it. However, the only qualms we have is its high price and low stocks online. It's big brother, the SteelSeries Stratus XL could have been a worthy contender in this comparison. Unfortunately, we couldn't include it because it was out of stock.

VERDICT

Best Performer and Editor's Pick - GameSir G5

No surprises in guessing the winner of the Best Performer award in this comparison. The GameSir G5 has brought the best features and build quality to the table while functioning as a gamepad should. All those extra buttons will come in handy when you're playing complex shooter or MOBA games. Even if you play basic platformer games, they will just be sitting there waiting to be used. The G5 also has a great ergonomic design ensuring your fingers don't cramp up after long gaming sessions. You will be able to comfortably reach all the buttons and analog sticks without having to perform finger gymnastics.

Providing an emulator is a powerful feature that isn't shared by the other gamepads giving this one an extra edge. Considering the endless list of features present on this gamepad, we would recommend the GameSir G5 only to advanced users who are going to take full advantage of the emulator. However, you're free to try your hands on this one if you're willing to go the extra mile with customisation.

Given the limited choice of games played using the G5 apart from the selected pool, we kept coming back to it. Having an interest in shooter games, especially PUBG Mobile, we took advantage of the public profile for the game and imported it. Initially, we found it a little difficult to aim with the touchpad. After a day, we were able to aim way better than with the analog stick, almost as good as using the touchscreen. Different controls were assigned individually to the extra buttons and we found it easier this way rather than searching for the button on the screen and then tapping. We certainly enjoyed a better experience using the G5. Hence, it also takes away the Editor's Pick.

Best Buy - Amigo STK AD2021

If you're looking for a gamepad that easily connects to your device and you're fine with mediocre build quality, then you should go for Amigo STK AD2021. However, you must know that you won't get a smartphone holder, so you will have to place the phone on the surface or make your own smartphone stand. Even though it states it's compatible with iOS, we couldn't get it to work. So, it may or may not work for you. This is strictly an entry-level gamepad for those who can't spend more than a grand or two. If you're on the lookout for a gamepad that doesn't cost a fortune while giving you good build quality and features, look no further than the Amkette Evo Gamepad Pro 2. 